

GSEB CLASS 10 SOCIAL SCIENCE

Chapter 3: Cultural Heritage of India: Sculpture and Architecture - Section B

SECTION B

Q1. In the religious field, which temples have been built in Gujarat?

- **Sun & Coastal Shrines:** Gujarat is home to architectural wonders like the famous Sun Temple at Modhera, the ancient Somnath Temple in Saurashtra, and the holy Dwarkadhish Temple in Dwarka.
- **Shakti Peethas & Hills:** Other major religious landmarks include the Ambaji Temple in Banaskantha and the Mahakali Temple situated atop the Pavagadh hill.
- **Additional Pilgrimages:** The state also features prominent structures like the Swaminarayan Temples, the Brahma Temple at Khedbrahma, and the Ranchhodraiji Temple at Dakor.
- **Spiritual Legacy:** These diverse temples represent a rich blend of architectural styles, attracting millions of devotees and highlighting Gujarat's long-standing religious traditions.

Q2. Which are the places in India where the remains of the Indus Valley Civilization have been discovered?

- **Core Sites in Gujarat:** Extensive archaeological remains have been discovered across Gujarat at major sites such as Lothal, Dholavira, Rangpur, and Rojdi.
- **Sites in Northern & Western India:** Major excavations include Harappa (now in Pakistan), Mohenjo-Daro, Kalibangan in Rajasthan, and Ropar in Punjab.
- **Additional Regions:** Discoveries have also been recorded at Banawali and Rakhigarhi in Haryana, as well as Alamgirpur in Uttar Pradesh.
- **Civilizational Spread:** These widespread sites prove that the Harappan or Indus Valley Civilization covered a massive geographical expanse across northwestern and western India.

Q3. Write about the stupa at Sanchi.

- **Geographical Location:** The Sanchi Stupa is a world-renowned Buddhist monument situated in the state of Madhya Pradesh.
- **Original Construction:** The original stupa structure was built of red bricks during the ancient Mauryan period under the patronage of Emperor Ashoka.
- **Dimensions & Design:** The initial construction was approximately half the size of the present-day structure, serving as a core center for early Buddhist worship.
- **Architectural Excellence:** It stands as a premier example of classic Buddhist architecture, featuring beautifully carved railings, gateways (Toranas), and a hemispherical dome.

Q4. Give information about the Pillar of Sarnath.

- **Historical Origin:** The monolithic stone pillar at Sarnath was erected by Emperor Ashoka and represents a peak of ancient Indian stone carving.
- **Sculptural Details:** At the top of the pillar, four majestic lions stand back-to-back, facing the four cardinal directions.
- **Emblem Figures:** The circular base features finely carved relief figures of an elephant, a horse, a bull, and an alternate depiction of the Dharmachakra (Wheel of Law).

- **National Symbolism:** The four-lion capital has been proudly adopted as the National Emblem of India, while the wheel appears prominently on the National Flag.

Q5. Explain the importance of architectural style of Gopuram.

- **Definition & Role:** In South Indian temple architecture, 'Gopuram' refers to the monumental, highly decorated entrance gateway leading into a temple enclosure.
- **Historical Evolution:** The architectural style of Gopurams gained immense prominence and grandeur during the rule of the Pandya dynasty.
- **Structural Grandeur:** These towers were built taller and more ornate than the main sanctum sanctorum, often dominating the visual landscape of the temple complex.
- **Artistic Mastery:** They feature dense, intricate sculptures of gods, goddesses, and mythological tales carved into tiered, pyramidal superstructures.

Q6. In which three main parts were the towns in the Indus Valley civilization divided?

- **Citadel (Fortified Area):** Located on an elevated platform on the western side of the town, primarily constructed for the ruling authorities and administrative chiefs.
- **Upper Town:** Situated on the eastern side of the settlement, inhabited by high officials, nobles, and wealthy merchants in multi-roomed structured houses.
- **Lower Town:** Built at ground level on the outer parts, serving as the residential area for common citizens, artisans, and working-class families.
- **Urban Planning:** This distinct three-tier structural division highlights the highly advanced town-planning and social organization of the Indus Valley Civilization.

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